Supplement 5: Empirical application II, Hallstatt/Iron Age burial data

Martin Hinz Nils Müller-Scheeßel

Table of contents

Aim 2
Computation . . . 2

Packages 3

Settings 3

Input data 4

Data preparation 5

Empirical chronological interval structure 7

Overlap structure 10

Standard proportional aoristic reconstruction 12

Monte Carlo aoristic reconstruction 13

Phase-corrected aoristic reconstruction 15

Baorista prior-sensitivity analysis 17

Reconstruction methods and overlap structure 19
Deviation from the overlap structure . . . 25

Strength of the overlap coupling 26

Pairwise method differences 27

Interpretation **30**

Session information **30**

References **31**

Aim

Supplement 4 applied the reconstruction comparison to Danish Neolithic site data. This supplement repeats the empirical comparison on a second dataset, Hallstatt/Iron Age burials with phase assignments.

The purpose is again methodological:

> How strongly do standard aoristic, Monte Carlo, phase-corrected and Bayesian reconstructions differ when applied to empirical phase-labelled archaeological observations?

The input data differ from the Danish case. Observations are assigned to named phases, whose start and end dates come from a separate lookup table.

Because the true generating process is unknown, we do not evaluate the methods against ground truth. Instead, we compare:

1. the structure and frequency of chronological phase labels;
2. the overlap structure of the corresponding chronological intervals;
3. the standard proportional aoristic reconstruction;
4. the Monte Carlo aoristic reconstruction;
5. the phase-corrected reconstruction;
6. the Bayesian reconstruction with Baorista as a model-based benchmark.

We ask in particular whether the reconstructed pattern is stable across methods or shaped by the chronological classification.

Computation

The Baorista fits for the four priors are computed with `scripts/run_s5_baorista_sensitivity.sh` (`make refresh-s5-baorista`), and this document reads their posterior summaries from `outputs/`. The full reproduction workflow is described in the README.

Packages

```
library(dplyr)
library(tidyr)
library(ggplot2)
library(purrr)
library(tibble)
library(readr)
library(rlang)
library(knitr)
```

Settings

```
set.seed(42)

dir.create("outputs", showWarnings = FALSE, recursive = TRUE)
dir.create("figures", showWarnings = FALSE, recursive = TRUE)

source("R/aoristic_helpers.R")

input_file <- "../data/hallstatt.tab"
phase_range_file <- "../data/hallstatt_phase_ranges.csv"

time_min <- -780L
time_max <- -451L

year_grid <- seq(time_min, time_max, by = 1)

bin_width <- 10L
n_mc <- 100L

max_interval_width <- Inf

baorista_rates <- c(1, 10, 50, 100)
baorista_reference_rate <- 1

baorista_file <- function(rate, suffix) {
  file.path("outputs", paste0("s5_hallstatt_baorista_rate_", rate, "_",
  ↪  suffix))
```

```
}
baorista_posterior_files <- setNames(
  vapply(baorista_rates, baorista_file, suffix = "posterior_binned.csv",
         FUN.VALUE = character(1)),
  baorista_rates
)
baorista_diagnostics_files <- setNames(
  vapply(baorista_rates, baorista_file, suffix = "diagnostics.csv",
         FUN.VALUE = character(1)),
  baorista_rates
)

method_colours <- c("Standard aoristic" = "#D55E00",
                    "Monte Carlo mean" = "#0072B2",
                    "Phase-corrected" = "#009E73",
                    "Baorista posterior median" = "#CC79A7")

method_linetypes <- c("Standard aoristic" = "solid",
                      "Monte Carlo mean" = "longdash",
                      "Phase-corrected" = "solid",
                      "Baorista posterior median" = "dotdash")
```

Input data

The Hallstatt/Iron Age dataset derives from the PhD dissertation by N. Müller-Scheeßel (2013) that dealt with the graves of the Hallstatt period in Southwestern and Southern Germany. The data are available at the repositorium of Tübingen University and the Zenodo account of Christoph Rinne, Kiel.

The reduced dataset (`hallstatt.tab`) consists of two tab-separated columns:

- an observation ID;
- a phase label.

The chronological ranges for these phase labels are stored separately in `hallstatt_phase_ranges.csv`. They are taken from the same source (Müller-Scheeßel, 2013).

```
if (!file.exists(input_file)) stop("Input file not found: ", input_file)
if (!file.exists(phase_range_file)) stop("Phase-range file not found: ",
 ↪  phase_range_file)
```

```
raw_iron_age <- read_tsv(input_file, col_names = c("id", "phase"),
                         show_col_types = FALSE)

phase_ranges <- read_csv(phase_range_file, show_col_types = FALSE)

required_phase_cols <- c("phase", "start", "end")

if (!all(required_phase_cols %in% names(phase_ranges))) {
  stop("Phase-range file must contain columns: ",
       paste(required_phase_cols, collapse = ", "), "\nAvailable columns: ",
       paste(names(phase_ranges), collapse = ", "))
}

input_settings <- tibble(
  setting = c("input_file", "phase_range_file", "time_min", "time_max",
              "bin_width", "max_interval_width", "n_mc"),
  value = c(input_file, phase_range_file, as.character(time_min),
            as.character(time_max), as.character(bin_width),
            as.character(max_interval_width), as.character(n_mc))
)

write_csv(input_settings, "outputs/s5_hallstatt_input_settings.csv")
```

Data preparation

The raw data are joined to the phase-range lookup table. The lookup table stores archaeological start and end dates. To keep the rest of the workflow consistent with the previous supplements, intervals are then converted to half-open form `[start, end)` by adding one year to the stored end date.

For example, a phase range from `-780` to `-721` becomes the half-open interval `[-780, -720)`.

```
unmatched_phases <- raw_iron_age |>
  distinct(phase) |>
  anti_join(phase_ranges, by = "phase") |>
  arrange(phase)

if (nrow(unmatched_phases) > 0) {
  stop(
    "The following phase labels are missing from the phase-range lookup
     ↪  table:\n",
```

```
    paste(unmatched_phases$phase, collapse = "\n")
  )
}

iron_age_events <- raw_iron_age |>
  left_join(
    phase_ranges |>
      select(phase, start_raw = start, end_raw = end, interval_width_raw =
       ↪  interval_width),
    by = "phase"
  ) |>
  mutate(start = as.integer(start_raw), end = as.integer(end_raw) + 1L,
         interval_width = end - start) |>
  filter(is.finite(start), is.finite(end), end > start, end > time_min,
         start < time_max + 1L) |>
  mutate(start = pmax(start, time_min), end = pmin(end, time_max + 1L),
         interval_width = end - start) |>
  filter(end > start, interval_width <= max_interval_width)

if (nrow(iron_age_events) == 0) {
  stop("No valid intervals remain after clipping to the analysis window.")
}

write_csv(iron_age_events, "outputs/s5_hallstatt_prepared_events.csv")
```

There are 2,242 entries altogether. Dating precision varies by a factor of 8 within this catalogue. The narrowest intervals cover 40 years, the widest 330, and the median sits at 120. Across the retained observations there are 13 distinct intervals in total.

A 40-year interval and a 330-year interval enter the sum with the same total weight. The shape of the reconstruction therefore depends on how many intervals of each width happen to exist, and not only on how many burials do.

```
data_summary <- tibble(
  metric = c("Number of records in raw data",
             "Number of records after filtering",
             "Share of raw records retained", "Earliest retained start",
             "Latest retained end", "Median interval width",
             "Minimum interval width", "Maximum interval width",
             "Number of unique retained intervals",
             "Number of unique retained phase labels"),
  value = c(nrow(raw_iron_age), nrow(iron_age_events),
```

Table 1: Summary statistics of the Hallstatt/Iron Age burial data.

	Value
Number of records in raw data	2,242
Number of records after filtering	2,242
Earliest retained start	-780
Latest retained end	-451
Median interval width	120
Minimum interval width	40
Maximum interval width	330
Number of unique retained intervals	13
Number of unique retained phase labels	13

```
            round(nrow(iron_age_events) / nrow(raw_iron_age), 3),
            min(iron_age_events$start, na.rm = TRUE),
            max(iron_age_events$end, na.rm = TRUE) - 1L,
            median(iron_age_events$interval_width, na.rm = TRUE),
            min(iron_age_events$interval_width, na.rm = TRUE),
            max(iron_age_events$interval_width, na.rm = TRUE),
            n_distinct(paste(iron_age_events$start, iron_age_events$end)),
            n_distinct(iron_age_events$phase))
)

write_csv(data_summary, "outputs/s5_hallstatt_data_summary.csv")

data_summary |>
  filter(metric != "Share of raw records retained") |>
  mutate(value = format(value, big.mark = ",", trim = TRUE, scientific =
   ↪  FALSE)) |>
  kbl(col.names = c("", "Value"), align = "lr")
```

Empirical chronological interval structure

The phase labels are translated into a relatively small number of chronological intervals. These intervals and their frequencies define the empirical dating structure that affects all aoristic reconstructions.

```
empirical_intervals <- iron_age_events |>
  distinct(start, end) |>
  arrange(start, end) |>
```

```
  mutate(interval_id = row_number(), end_label = end - 1L, width = end -
   ↪  start)

write_csv(empirical_intervals, "outputs/s5_hallstatt_unique_intervals.csv")
```

The distribution of intervals is uneven, although less concentrated than in the Danish data. 660–540 BCE carries 489 observations and 780–450 BCE a further 373. Between them, these two labels account for 38.4% of the dataset.

```
interval_counts <- iron_age_events |>
  count(phase, start, end, interval_width, name = "n") |>
  mutate(end_label = end - 1L, share = n / sum(n)) |>
  arrange(desc(n), start, end, phase)

write_csv(interval_counts, "outputs/s5_hallstatt_interval_counts.csv")

interval_concentration <- interval_counts |>
  arrange(desc(n)) |>
  mutate(rank = row_number(), share = n / sum(n),
         cumulative_share = cumsum(share))

write_csv(interval_concentration,
          "outputs/s5_hallstatt_interval_concentration.csv")

interval_concentration |>
  slice_head(n = 10) |>
  transmute(Rank = rank, `Interval (BCE)` = paste0(abs(start), "-",
   ↪  abs(end)),
            `Width (years)` = interval_width, Records = n,
            `Share (%)` = round(100 * share, 1),
            `Cumulative (%)` = round(100 * cumulative_share, 1)) |>
kbl()
```

```
p_interval_widths <- ggplot(iron_age_events, aes(x = interval_width)) +
  geom_histogram(bins = 20) +
  labs(
    title = "Dating precision in the Hallstatt/Iron Age dataset",
    subtitle = "Distribution of chronological interval widths after phase
     ↪  lookup",
    x = "Interval width in years",
    y = "Number of observations"
```

Table 2: The ten most frequent dating intervals in the Hallstatt/Iron Age burial data.

Rank	Interval (BCE)	Width (years)	Records	Share (%)	Cumulative (%)
1	660–540	120	489	21.8	21.8
2	780–450	330	373	16.6	38.4
3	660–450	210	299	13.3	51.8
4	780–660	120	252	11.2	63.0
5	720–660	60	147	6.6	69.6
6	500–450	50	138	6.2	75.7
7	720–540	180	129	5.8	81.5
8	540–450	90	112	5.0	86.5
9	780–540	240	110	4.9	91.4
10	780–720	60	68	3.0	94.4

```
  ) +
  plot_theme(base_size = 9)

p_interval_widths
```

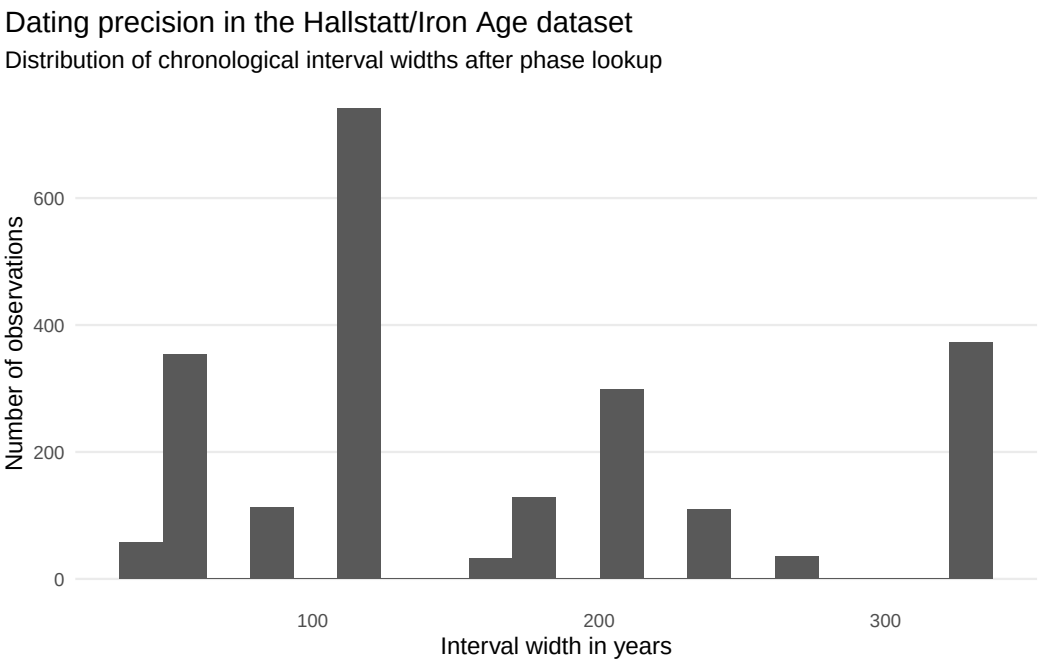


Figure 1: Distribution of the interval widths after phase lookup.

```
p_interval_counts <- interval_counts |>
  mutate(interval_label = paste0(phase, " (", start, " to ", end_label, ")"),
```

```
        interval_label = reorder(interval_label, n)) |>
  ggplot(aes(x = n, y = interval_label)) +
  geom_col() +
  labs(title = "Most frequent Hallstatt/Iron Age chronological intervals",
       subtitle = "Phase labels and their mapped chronological ranges",
       x = "Number of observations", y = NULL) +
  plot_theme(base_size = 8)

p_interval_counts
```

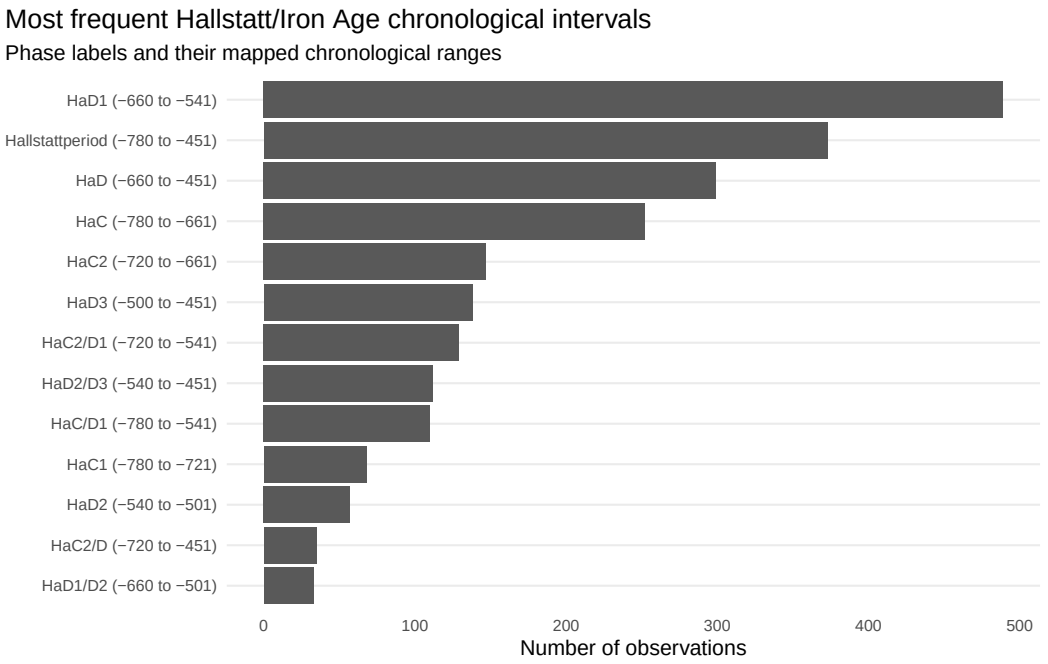


Figure 2: Frequency of the phase labels and their chronological ranges.

As in the simulations, the data are an uneven mixture of broad and narrow intervals, and the resulting curve may reflect past burial activity, the structure of the chronological attribution, or both.

Overlap structure

For each year, we count how many unique chronological intervals cover that year. This gives the overlap structure of the empirical phase system. High values indicate parts of the chronology where many phase labels or dating ranges overlap.

```r
overlap_curve <- count_phase_overlap(
  phase_catalogue = empirical_intervals |>
    transmute(from = start, to = end),
  year_grid = year_grid
)

overlap_curve_binned <- bin_overlap_curve(
  overlap_curve = overlap_curve, bin_width = bin_width, bin_start = time_min
)

write_csv(overlap_curve_binned,
 ↪  "outputs/s5_hallstatt_overlap_curve_binned.csv")
```

```r
p_overlap <- ggplot(overlap_curve_binned, aes(x = year, y = overlap)) +
  geom_line(linewidth = 0.8) +
  geom_point(size = 1.2) + coord_cartesian(ylim = c(0, 7)) +
  labs(
    title = "Empirical overlap structure of Hallstatt/Iron Age phase
     ↪  intervals",
    subtitle = "Number of unique chronological intervals covering each time
     ↪  bin",
    x = "\nYear BCE/CE",
    y = "Mean number of overlapping intervals\n"
  ) +
  plot_theme(base_size = 9)

p_overlap
```

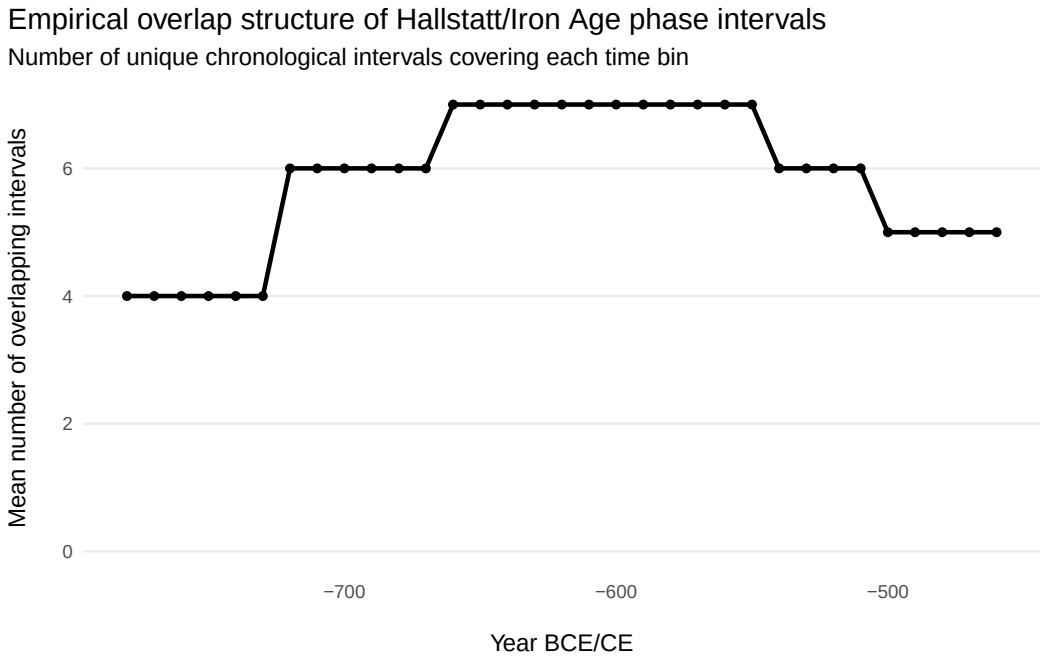


Figure 3: Empirical overlap structure, given as the mean number of unique intervals covering each 10-year bin.

As in Supplement 4, the curve counts the distinct intervals covering a given time and says nothing about the number of burials. As shown in the previous supplements, where an empirical reconstruction tracks the overlap curve, part of the reconstructed trajectory may derive from the chronological classification instead from past activity.

Standard proportional aoristic reconstruction

The standard aoristic method distributes each observation uniformly across its assigned chronological interval.

```
standard_curve <- run_standard_aoristic(intervals = iron_age_events,
                                        year_grid = year_grid)

standard_curve_binned <- standard_curve |>
  make_reconstruction_binned(value_col = standard, output_col = "standard",
                             bin_width = bin_width, bin_start = time_min)

write_csv(standard_curve_binned,
          "outputs/s5_hallstatt_standard_aoristic_binned.csv")
```

For the Hallstatt/Iron Age burial data this produces a rather flat curve with some internal structure and a pronounced dip in 540–501 BCE. Many observations carry very wide dating intervals, so a substantial share of the evidence is smeared across long stretches of time. The curve records the distribution of datings as much as the number of observations.

```
p_standard <- ggplot(standard_curve_binned, aes(x = year, y = standard)) +
  geom_line(colour = method_colours[["Standard aoristic"]], linewidth = 0.8,
            na.rm = TRUE) +
  labs(title = "Standard proportional aoristic reconstruction from the
   ↪  Hallstatt/Iron Age dataset",
       subtitle = "Binned and normalised to sum to one", x = "Year BCE/CE",
       y = "Normalised intensity") +
  plot_theme(base_size = 9) + coord_cartesian(ylim = c(0, 0.04))

p_standard
```



Figure 4: Standard proportional aoristic reconstruction, binned and normalised to sum to one.

Monte Carlo aoristic reconstruction

As in Supplements 2 and 4, the Monte Carlo reconstruction repeatedly samples one possible date for each observation from its assigned interval. It expresses uncertainty under the standard

within-interval uniformity assumption.

```
mc_curve_binned <- run_monte_carlo_aoristic(
  intervals = iron_age_events,
  year_grid = year_grid,
  bin_width = bin_width,
  bin_start = time_min,
  n_iter = n_mc,
  seed = 52001
)

write_csv(mc_curve_binned, "outputs/s5_hallstatt_monte_carlo_binned.csv")
```

Setting the uncertainty envelope aside, the Monte Carlo reconstruction is nearly identical to the simple proportional one, as the simulations led us to expect.

```
p_mc <- ggplot(mc_curve_binned, aes(x = year)) +
  geom_ribbon(aes(ymin = mc_q05, ymax = mc_q95), alpha = 0.20, na.rm = TRUE)
   ↪  +
  geom_line(aes(y = mc_mean), colour = method_colours[["Monte Carlo mean"]],
            linewidth = 0.8, na.rm = TRUE) +
  labs(
    title = "Monte Carlo aoristic uncertainty for the Hallstatt/Iron Age
     ↪  dataset",
    subtitle = paste0("Ribbon: 5th to 95th percentile interval across ",
     ↪  n_mc, " iterations"),
    x = "Year BCE/CE",
    y = "Normalised intensity"
  ) +
  plot_theme(base_size = 9) + coord_cartesian(ylim = c(0, 0.05))

p_mc
```

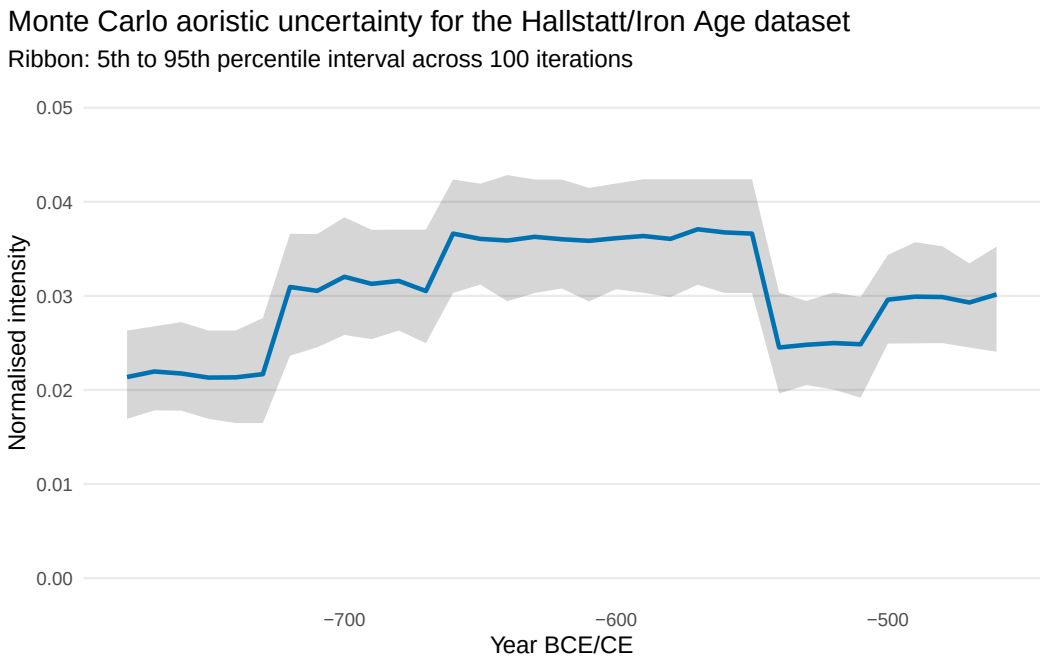


Figure 5: Monte Carlo aoristic reconstruction with the 5th to 95th percentile interval across the iterations.

Phase-corrected aoristic reconstruction

The phase-corrected method reduces the weight assigned to years covered by many overlapping chronological intervals.

```
phase_corrected_curve <- run_phase_corrected_aoristic(
  intervals = iron_age_events, year_grid = year_grid
)

phase_corrected_curve_binned <- phase_corrected_curve |>
  make_reconstruction_binned(value_col = phase_corrected,
                             output_col = "phase_corrected",
                             bin_width = bin_width, bin_start = time_min)

write_csv(phase_corrected_curve_binned,
          "outputs/s5_hallstatt_phase_corrected_binned.csv")
```

The phase-corrected curve departs substantially from the others. Its correlation with the standard aoristic curve is 0.894, and here too part of the probability is moved between periods. Where the two differ, the interpretation depends on the method.

```r
p_phase_corrected <- phase_corrected_curve_binned |>
  inner_join(standard_curve_binned, by = "year") |>
  ggplot(aes(x = year)) +
  geom_line(aes(y = standard), colour = "grey60", linetype = "dashed",
            linewidth = 0.6, na.rm = TRUE) +
  geom_line(aes(y = phase_corrected),
            colour = method_colours[["Phase-corrected"]], linewidth = 0.8,
            na.rm = TRUE) +
  labs(
    title = "Phase-corrected aoristic reconstruction for the Hallstatt/Iron
     ↪  Age dataset",
    subtitle = "Binned and normalised to sum to one; dashed grey line:
     ↪  standard reconstruction for reference",
    x = "Year BCE/CE",
    y = "Normalised intensity"
  ) +
  plot_theme(base_size = 9) + coord_cartesian(ylim = c(0, 0.04))

p_phase_corrected
```

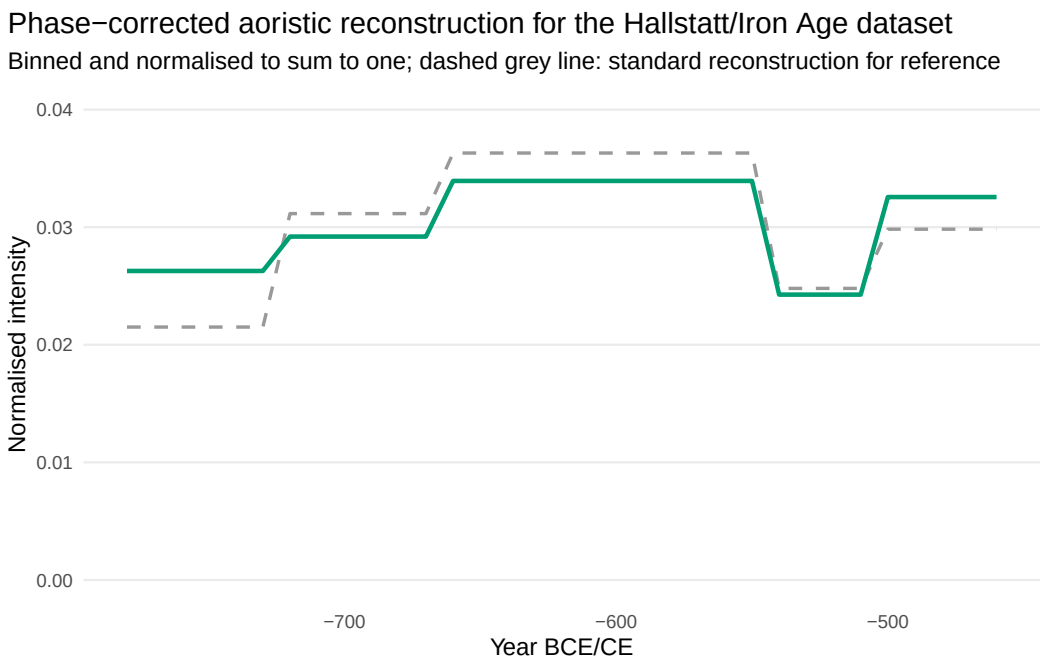


Figure 6: Phase-corrected reconstruction compared with the standard reconstruction (dashed grey line).

Baorista prior-sensitivity analysis

As in Supplement 4 for the Danish data, the Bayesian reconstruction of the Hallstatt data with Baorista (Crema, 2025) is evaluated under four exponential priors for the ICAR scale parameter, with rates of 1, 10, 50 and 100. All four are fitted to the same 2,242 records (13 unique intervals) in 10-year blocks, with the MCMC settings of Supplement 4. The panels show the posterior mean with pointwise 95% credible intervals. The method comparisons below use the posterior median of the fit with rate 1.

```
if (!all(file.exists(c(baorista_posterior_files,
 ↪  baorista_diagnostics_files)))) {
  stop("Run scripts/run_s5_baorista_sensitivity.sh first.")
}

baorista_sensitivity_posterior <- map_dfr(baorista_rates, function(rate) {
  read_csv(baorista_posterior_files[[as.character(rate)]], show_col_types =
   ↪  FALSE) |>
    mutate(sigma_prior_rate = rate, sigma_prior = paste0("dexp(rate=", rate,
     ↪  ")"))
})

baorista_sensitivity_diagnostics <- map_dfr(baorista_rates, function(rate) {
  read_csv(baorista_diagnostics_files[[as.character(rate)]], show_col_types =
   ↪  FALSE) |>
    mutate(sigma_prior_rate = rate)
}) |>
  filter(diagnostic %in% c("max_rhat", "median_rhat", "min_ess",
   ↪  "median_ess",
                           "n_posterior_samples", "niter", "n_attempts",
                            ↪  "converged")) |>
  mutate(value = as.numeric(value)) |>
  select(sigma_prior_rate, diagnostic, value) |>
  pivot_wider(names_from = diagnostic, values_from = value) |>
  arrange(sigma_prior_rate)

baorista_sensitivity_diagnostics |>
  transmute(`Prior rate` = as.character(sigma_prior_rate),
            `Max R-hat` = formatC(max_rhat, format = "f", digits = 3),
            `Median R-hat` = formatC(median_rhat, format = "f", digits = 3),
            `Min ESS` = format(round(min_ess), big.mark = ","),
            `Median ESS` = format(round(median_ess), big.mark = ","),
            Draws = format(n_posterior_samples, big.mark = ","),
            Iterations = format(niter, big.mark = ","),
```

Table 3: Convergence diagnostics for the Baorista prior-sensitivity fits.

Prior rate	Max R-hat	Median R-hat	Min ESS	Median ESS	Draws	Iterations	Attempts	Converged
1	1.023	1.004	310	1,602	2,000	50,000	1	yes
10	1.016	1.003	1,351	1,777	2,000	50,000	1	yes
50	1.011	1.001	1,262	2,000	2,000	50,000	1	yes
100	1.010	1.003	1,459	1,812	2,000	50,000	1	yes

```
            Attempts = n_attempts,
            Converged = if_else(converged == 1, "yes", "no")) |>
  kbl(align = "lrrrrrrrr")
```

```
p_baorista_sensitivity <- baorista_sensitivity_posterior |>
  mutate(sigma_prior = factor(sigma_prior,
                              levels = paste0("dexp(rate=", baorista_rates,
                               ↪  ")"))) |>
  ggplot(aes(x = year, y = baorista_mean)) +
  geom_ribbon(aes(ymin = baorista_q025, ymax = baorista_q975), alpha = 0.18)
   ↪  +
  geom_line(linewidth = 0.8) +
  facet_wrap(vars(sigma_prior), ncol = 2, scales = "free_y") +
  labs(title = "Hallstatt/Iron Age data: Baorista prior-sensitivity
   ↪  analysis",
       subtitle = "Posterior mean and pointwise 95% credible interval",
       x = "Year BCE/CE", y = "Posterior probability") +
  plot_theme(base_size = 9)

p_baorista_sensitivity
```

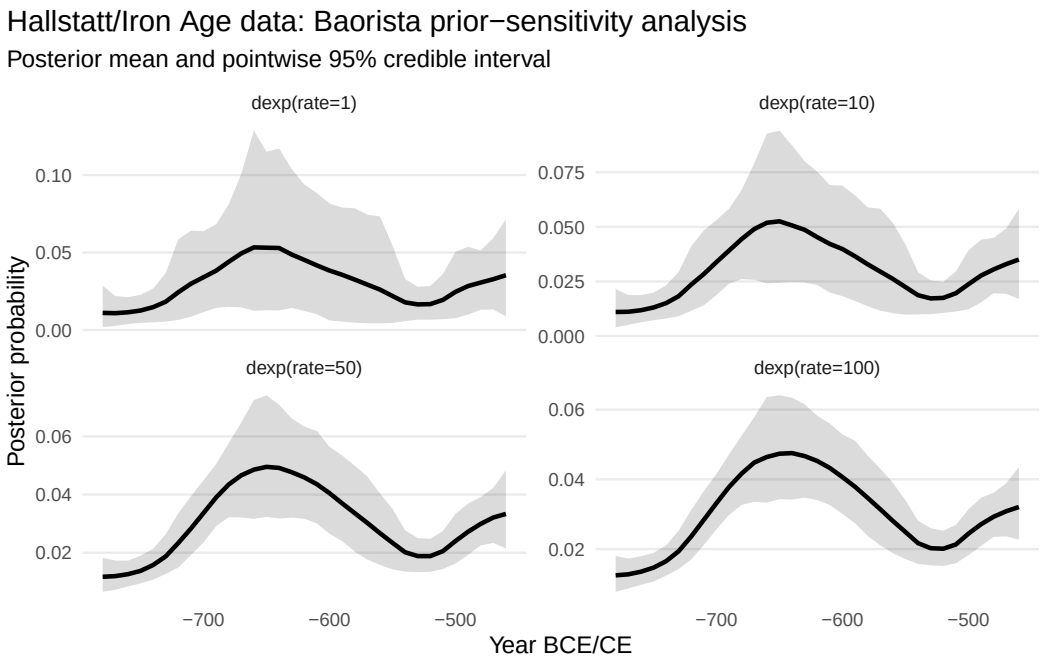


Figure 7: Baorista reconstructions of the Hallstatt burial data under four priors for the ICAR scale parameter. Posterior mean and pointwise 95% credible interval.

All four fits reached the convergence criterion in the first attempt (Table 3). As in the Danish data, the prior affects amplitude and smoothness but not the shape of the posterior (Figure 7). In all four fits, the posterior median reaches its maximum in 650–631 BCE, at the beginning of HaD1, where the overlap curve reaches its maximum and most labels meet. The reconstruction thus concentrates probability where many intervals intersect, as expected for likelihood-based estimates on interval-censored data (Turnbull, 1976). It also reproduces the low density in HaD2 and the rise in HaD3 seen in the aoristic reconstructions.

Reconstruction methods and overlap structure

```
curves_binned <- overlap_curve_binned |>
  left_join(standard_curve_binned, by = "year") |>
  left_join(
    mc_curve_binned |>
      select(year, mc_mean, mc_median, mc_q05, mc_q95),
    by = "year"
  ) |>
  left_join(phase_corrected_curve_binned, by = "year") |>
```

```
  left_join(
    read_csv(baorista_posterior_files[[as.character
     ↪  (baorista_reference_rate)]],
             show_col_types = FALSE) |>
      select(year, baorista_median, baorista_q025, baorista_q975),
    by = "year"
  ) |>
  mutate(overlap = replace_na(overlap, 0),
         standard = normalise_curve(replace_na(standard, 0)),
         mc_mean = normalise_curve(replace_na(mc_mean, 0)),
         mc_median = normalise_curve(replace_na(mc_median, 0)),
         phase_corrected = normalise_curve(replace_na(phase_corrected, 0)),
         baorista_median = replace_na(baorista_median, 0),
         baorista_q025 = replace_na(baorista_q025, 0),
         baorista_q975 = replace_na(baorista_q975, 0))

write_csv(curves_binned,
          "outputs/s5_hallstatt_reconstruction_curves_binned.csv")
```

Without ground truth, we quantify the association between each reconstruction and the empirical overlap structure.

```
overlap_diagnostics <- curves_binned |>
  select(overlap, standard, mc_mean, phase_corrected, baorista_median) |>
  summarise(standard = safe_cor(overlap, standard),
            mc_mean = safe_cor(overlap, mc_mean),
            phase_corrected = safe_cor(overlap, phase_corrected),
            baorista_median = safe_cor(overlap, baorista_median)) |>
  pivot_longer(cols = everything(), names_to = "method",
               values_to = "overlap_curve_correlation") |>
  mutate(
    method = recode(method, standard = "Standard aoristic",
                    mc_mean = "Monte Carlo mean",
                    phase_corrected = "Phase-corrected",
                    baorista_median = "Baorista posterior median")
  ) |>
  arrange(desc(abs(overlap_curve_correlation))) |>
  mutate(
    overlap_relative_amplitude = map_dbl(
      method,
      ~ overlap_relative_amplitude(
          curves_binned[[c("Standard aoristic" = "standard",
```

Table 4: Hallstatt/Iron Age data: correlation of each reconstruction with the overlap structure and overlap-aligned relative amplitude.

Method	Correlation with overlap	Overlap-aligned relative amplitude
Standard aoristic	0.887	0.163
Monte Carlo mean	0.885	0.163
Baorista posterior median	0.650	0.278
Phase-corrected	0.610	0.073

```
                            "Monte Carlo mean" = "mc_mean",
                            "Phase-corrected" = "phase_corrected",
                            "Baorista posterior median" =
                             ↪  "baorista_median")[[.x]]]],
          curves_binned$overlap
        )
    )
  )

write_csv(overlap_diagnostics,
 ↪  "outputs/s5_hallstatt_overlap_diagnostics.csv")

overlap_diagnostics |>
  select(method, overlap_curve_correlation, overlap_relative_amplitude) |>
  kbl(
    digits = 3,
    col.names = c("Method", "Correlation with overlap", "Overlap-aligned
     ↪  relative amplitude")
  )
```

```
p_overlap_correlation <- overlap_diagnostics |>
  mutate(method = reorder(method, abs(overlap_curve_correlation))) |>
  ggplot(aes(x = overlap_curve_correlation, y = method)) +
  geom_col() +
  geom_vline(xintercept = 0, linewidth = 0.4) +
  labs(
    title = "Hallstatt data: reconstructions and phase overlap",
    subtitle = "Correlation between each method and the empirical overlap
     ↪  curve",
    x = "\nCorrelation with overlap structure",
    y = NULL
  ) +
```

```
  plot_theme(base_size = 9)

p_overlap_correlation
```

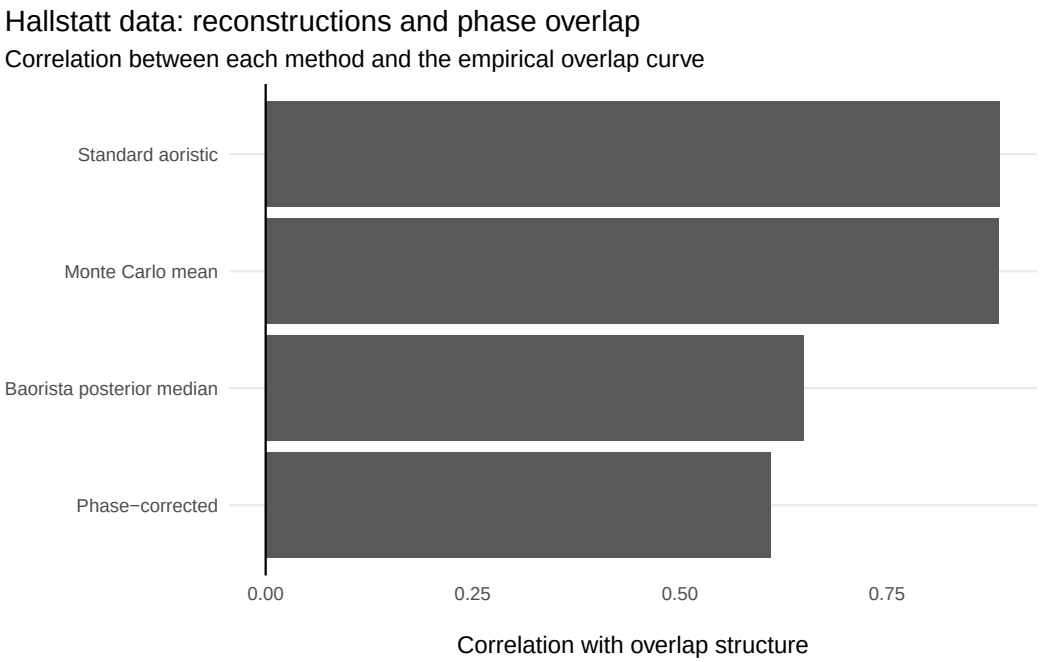


Figure 8: Correlation between each reconstruction and the empirical overlap curve.

The standard proportional result correlates with the empirical overlap curve at 0.887 and the Monte Carlo result at 0.885. The phase-corrected reconstruction drops to 0.610, with the Baorista posterior median between the two at 0.650. As in the Danish data, the lower correlation of Baorista does not imply weaker coupling, as its overlap-aligned amplitude shows below.

Where a reconstruction follows the overlap curve closely, it may be partly driven by the chronological classification.

```
plot_overlap_methods <- curves_binned |>
  mutate(overlap_scaled = normalise_curve(overlap)) |>
  select(year, Overlap_structure = overlap_scaled, Standard_aoristic =
   ↪  standard,
         Monte_Carlo_mean = mc_mean, Phase_corrected = phase_corrected,
         Baorista_posterior_median = baorista_median) |>
  pivot_longer(cols = -year, names_to = "method", values_to = "value") |>
```

```
  mutate(
    method = recode(method, Overlap_structure = "Overlap structure",
                    Standard_aoristic = "Standard aoristic",
                    Monte_Carlo_mean = "Monte Carlo mean",
                    Phase_corrected = "Phase-corrected",
                    Baorista_posterior_median = "Baorista posterior median"),
    method = factor(method, levels = c("Overlap structure",
     ↪  names(method_colours)))
  )

overlap_colours <- c("Overlap structure" = "black", method_colours)

overlap_linetypes <- c("Overlap structure" = "dotted", method_linetypes)

p_overlap_methods <- ggplot(
  plot_overlap_methods,
  aes(x = year, y = value, colour = method, linetype = method)
) +
  geom_ribbon(data = curves_binned,
              aes(x = year, ymin = baorista_q025, ymax = baorista_q975),
              inherit.aes = FALSE, fill = "#CC79A7", alpha = 0.08) +
  geom_line(linewidth = 0.8, na.rm = TRUE) +
  scale_colour_manual(values = overlap_colours, drop = FALSE) +
  scale_linetype_manual(values = overlap_linetypes, drop = FALSE) +
  labs(title = "Hallstatt/Iron Age data: reconstruction methods and empirical
   ↪  phase-overlap structure",
       subtitle = "All curves are normalised for visual comparison; shaded:
        ↪  Baorista 95% credible interval",
       x = "\nYear BCE/CE", y = "Normalised value\n") +
  plot_theme(base_size = 9)

p_overlap_methods
```

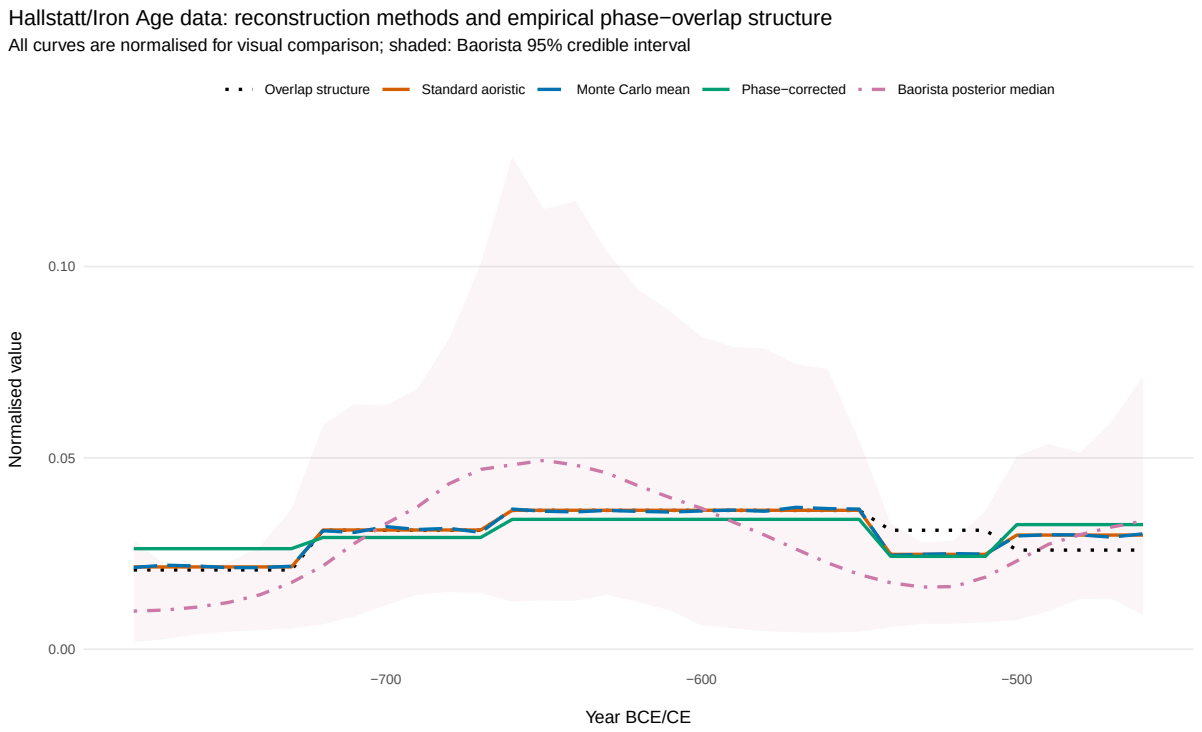


Figure 9: Reconstruction methods and empirical overlap structure, all normalised to sum to one. The shaded band is the 95% credible interval of the Baorista reconstruction.

Standard and Monte Carlo overlap almost perfectly (Figure 9). The phase-corrected curve shifts the relative weight of several periods while keeping much of the broad trajectory.

The curves differ most at the beginning and end of the Hallstatt period. These sections are sensitive to the combined effect of reconstruction method and chronological classification and should not be read directly as demographic events.

In the earlier part of the sequence, the phase-corrected curve tends to be lower where overlap is high, in the later part it does not. An exact correction would leave no relationship with the overlap curve, so a negative local relationship reflects either a real signal that runs against the catalogue or overcompensation. Since label use in these data is much closer to equal choice than in the Danish case (Supplement 6), overcompensation should be small here, but this comparison alone cannot separate the two.

```
ggsave("figures/s5_hallstatt_methods_vs_overlap.png", p_overlap_methods,
       width = 8.5, height = 5.2, dpi = 600)
```

Deviation from the overlap structure

The difference between each normalised reconstruction and the normalised overlap curve shows where along the sequence the reconstructions depart from the catalogue (Figure 10). A reconstruction that only reproduced the catalogue would stay close to zero throughout. The standard and Monte Carlo curves do so except in HaD2 and HaD3. The phase-corrected curve lies above the overlap curve in the earliest Hallstatt phases and below it in HaD1, where most labels overlap. Baorista departs most, with low values at the beginning of the sequence and a pronounced excess around its maximum in HaD1.

```
p_deviation <- curves_binned |>
  mutate(overlap_scaled = normalise_curve(overlap)) |>
  transmute(year,
            `Standard aoristic` = standard - overlap_scaled,
            `Monte Carlo mean` = mc_mean - overlap_scaled,
            `Phase-corrected` = phase_corrected - overlap_scaled,
            `Baorista posterior median` = baorista_median - overlap_scaled)
             ↪  |>
  pivot_longer(-year, names_to = "method", values_to = "deviation") |>
  mutate(method = factor(method, levels = names(method_colours))) |>
  ggplot(aes(x = year, y = deviation, colour = method, linetype = method)) +
  geom_hline(yintercept = 0, linewidth = 0.3) +
  geom_line(linewidth = 0.8, na.rm = TRUE, show.legend = FALSE) +
  facet_wrap(vars(method), ncol = 2) +
  scale_colour_manual(values = method_colours) +
  scale_linetype_manual(values = method_linetypes) +
  labs(title = "Hallstatt/Iron Age data: deviation of the reconstructions
   ↪  from the overlap structure",
       subtitle = "Normalised reconstruction minus normalised overlap curve",
       x = "Year BCE/CE", y = "Difference in normalised density") +
  plot_theme(base_size = 9)

p_deviation
```

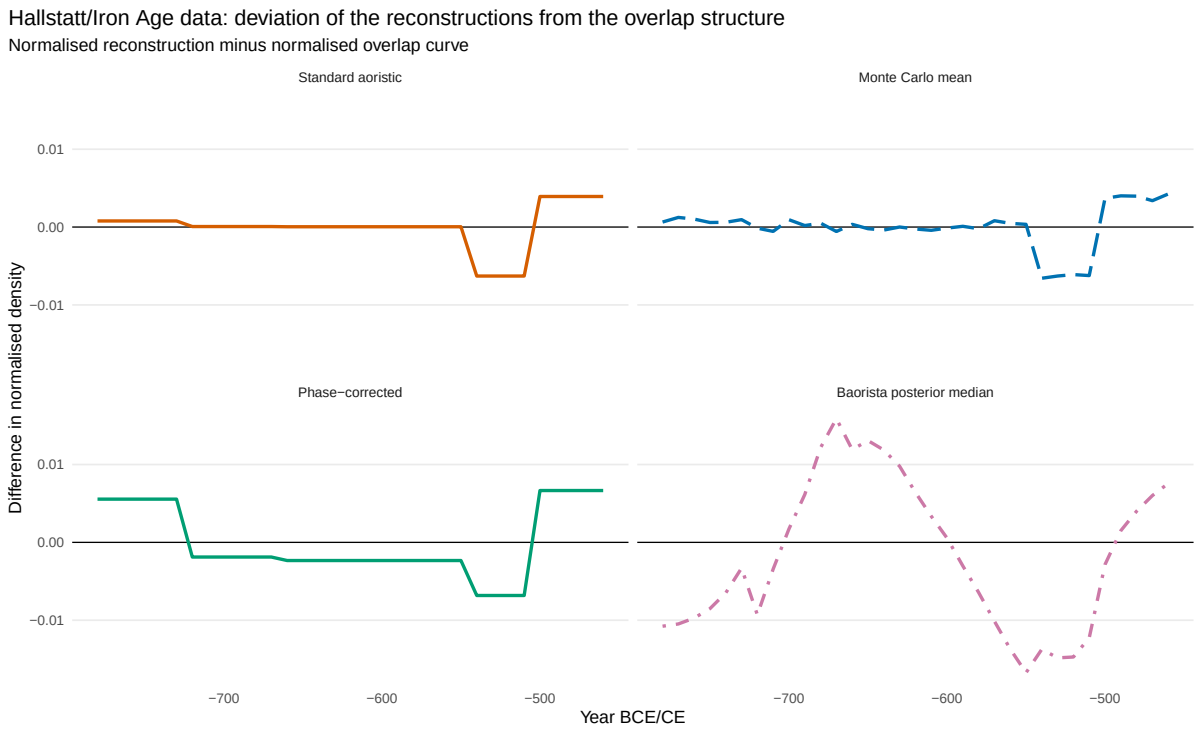


Figure 10: Deviation of the reconstructions from the overlap structure, given as normalised reconstruction minus normalised overlap curve.

Strength of the overlap coupling

As in Supplements 2 and 4, we complement the correlations with the overlap-aligned relative amplitude, $|\beta| \cdot \mathrm{sd}(\lambda)/\bar{R}$, with β the slope of the reconstruction on the overlap curve: the change in reconstructed density, as a fraction of the mean density, when the overlap increases by one standard deviation (see Supplement 2). All curves are normalised to the same total, so the values are comparable across methods.

```
s5_strength <- overlap_diagnostics |>
  select(method, overlap_curve_correlation, overlap_relative_amplitude)

amp <- function(m) s5_strength$overlap_relative_amplitude[s5_strength$method
 ↪  == m]
```

For the standard reconstruction, the density rises by about 16% of the mean per standard deviation of overlap, for the phase-corrected reconstruction by about 7%, and for the Baorista posterior median by about 28%.

```
p_overlap_scatter <- plot_overlap_scatter(
  curves = curves_binned,
  method_cols = c("standard", "mc_mean", "phase_corrected",
   ↪  "baorista_median"),
  method_labels = c(standard = "Standard aoristic",
                    mc_mean = "Monte Carlo mean",
                    phase_corrected = "Phase-corrected",
                    baorista_median = "Baorista posterior median"),
  colours = method_colours
) +
  labs(title = "Hallstatt/Iron Age data: reconstructed density against phase
   ↪  overlap")

p_overlap_scatter
```

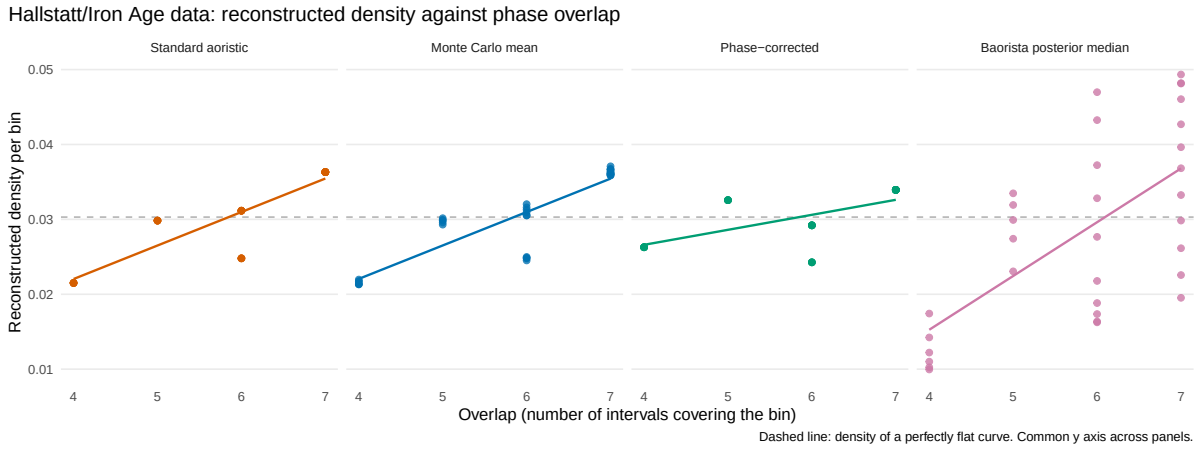


Figure 11: Reconstructed density against phase overlap, by method.

Pairwise method differences

Because there is no known ground truth, we evaluate how strongly the methods differ from one another.

```
method_matrix <- curves_binned |>
  select(standard, mc_mean, phase_corrected, baorista_median)

pairwise_method_correlations <- cor(method_matrix,
                                    use = "pairwise.complete.obs") |>
```

```
  as.data.frame() |>
  rownames_to_column("method_1") |>
  pivot_longer(cols = -method_1, names_to = "method_2",
               values_to = "correlation") |>
  mutate(
    method_1 = recode(method_1, standard = "Standard aoristic",
                      mc_mean = "Monte Carlo mean",
                      phase_corrected = "Phase-corrected",
                      baorista_median = "Baorista posterior median"),
    method_2 = recode(method_2, standard = "Standard aoristic",
                      mc_mean = "Monte Carlo mean",
                      phase_corrected = "Phase-corrected",
                      baorista_median = "Baorista posterior median")
  )

write_csv(pairwise_method_correlations,
          "outputs/s5_hallstatt_pairwise_method_correlations.csv")
```

```
pairwise_method_distances <- expand_grid(
  method_1 = names(method_matrix), method_2 = names(method_matrix)
  ) |>
  mutate(
    rmsd = map2_dbl(method_1, method_2,
                    ~ rmsd(method_matrix[[.x]], method_matrix[[.y]])),
    mae = map2_dbl(method_1, method_2,
                   ~ mae(method_matrix[[.x]], method_matrix[[.y]])),
    method_1 = recode(method_1, standard = "Standard aoristic",
                      mc_mean = "Monte Carlo mean",
                      phase_corrected = "Phase-corrected",
                      baorista_median = "Baorista posterior median"),
    method_2 = recode(method_2, standard = "Standard aoristic",
                      mc_mean = "Monte Carlo mean",
                      phase_corrected = "Phase-corrected",
                      baorista_median = "Baorista posterior median")
  )
```

```
pairwise_labels <- c("Standard aoristic" = "Standard",
                     "Monte Carlo mean" = "Monte Carlo",
                     "Phase-corrected" = "Phase-corrected",
                     "Baorista posterior median" = "Baorista")
pairwise_order <- names(pairwise_labels)
```

Table 5: Hallstatt/Iron Age data: pairwise comparison of the reconstructions. Below the diagonal: correlation; above the diagonal: RMSD (×1000) between the binned, normalised curves.

	Standard	Monte Carlo	Phase-corrected	Baorista
Standard	–	0.36	2.84	8.86
Monte Carlo	0.998	–	2.85	8.96
Phase-corrected	0.894	0.892	–	10.26
Baorista	0.769	0.757	0.676	–

```
pairwise_table <- matrix("-", nrow = length(pairwise_order),
                         ncol = length(pairwise_order),
                         dimnames = list(pairwise_labels, pairwise_labels))

for (i in seq_along(pairwise_order)) {
  for (j in seq_along(pairwise_order)) {
    if (i > j) {
      pairwise_table[i, j] <- formatC(
        pairwise_method_correlations$correlation[
          pairwise_method_correlations$method_1 == pairwise_order[i] &
            pairwise_method_correlations$method_2 == pairwise_order[j]
        ],
        format = "f", digits = 3
      )
    } else if (i < j) {
      pairwise_table[i, j] <- formatC(
        1000 * pairwise_method_distances$rmsd[
          pairwise_method_distances$method_1 == pairwise_order[i] &
            pairwise_method_distances$method_2 == pairwise_order[j]
        ],
        format = "f", digits = 2
      )
    }
  }
}

kbl(pairwise_table, align = "rrrr")
```

The Monte Carlo mean and the standard aoristic result are numerically almost the same curve. The phase-corrected reconstruction stays recognisably related to both, but RMSD shows it moving a substantial amount of probability between periods.

Interpretation

The Hallstatt burial data again show that how much the phase correction changes the standard reconstruction depends on the distribution of phase labels and on the overlap structure of their intervals.

Standard and Monte Carlo aoristics share a central tendency because they share the within-interval uniformity assumption. The phase correction changes the relative prominence of several periods. Its much lower correlation with the overlap curve and its smaller overlap-aligned amplitude indicate that the standard reconstruction is partly structured by the intervals, as in the simulations. Baorista correlates less closely with the overlap curve than the standard reconstruction, but its overlap-aligned amplitude is the largest of all methods, and it concentrates probability where most labels meet, as in the Danish data. Since all Baorista fits converged here, this cannot be attributed to the sampling.

In HaD2 (540–501 BCE), all reconstructions lie below the overlap curve, and in HaD3 (500–451 BCE) above it. Since this deviation persists after the correction, overlap is not the only issue. Interval-based reconstructions are also sensitive to the absolute duration and placement of the ranges they are given, and the pattern would fit a HaD2 that was considerably shorter, and a HaD3 correspondingly longer, than the phase boundaries used here assume.

The limits of the comparison are those of any empirical test without ground truth. The case study cannot show that the corrected curve is the true trajectory of burial activity. As in the Danish case study, however, the comparison identifies those periods in which an interpretation depends on the classification and the method.

The conclusions of Supplement 4 apply here with fewer reservations. Label use is close to equal choice, and the standard reconstruction is strongly coupled to the overlap structure, so the corrected curve is in our view the better-founded estimate. Where the two differ in parts of the sequence in which the true signal may plausibly be concentrated, both should be reported and the difference discussed.

Session information

```
sessionInfo()
```

```
R version 4.5.3 (2026-03-11)
Platform: aarch64-apple-darwin20
Running under: macOS 27.2.1

Matrix products: default
```

```
BLAS:   /Library/Frameworks/R.framework/Versions/4.5-arm64/Resources/lib/lib
 ↪  Rblas.0.dylib
LAPACK: /Library/Frameworks/R.framework/Versions/4.5-arm64/Resources/lib/lib
 ↪  Rlapack.dylib;  LAPACK version 3.12.1

locale:
[1] en_US.UTF-8/en_US.UTF-8/en_US.UTF-8/C/en_US.UTF-8/en_US.UTF-8

time zone: Europe/Berlin
tzcode source: internal

attached base packages:
[1] stats     graphics  grDevices datasets  utils     methods   base

other attached packages:
[1] knitr_1.50    rlang_1.3.0   readr_2.1.6   tibble_3.3.1  purrr_1.2.0
[6] ggplot2_4.0.3 tidyr_1.3.1   dplyr_1.2.1

loaded via a namespace (and not attached):
 [1] Matrix_1.7-4       bit_4.6.0          gtable_0.3.6       jsonlite_2.0.0
 [5] crayon_1.5.3       compiler_4.5.3     renv_1.2.0         tinytex_0.59
 [9] tidyselect_1.2.1   parallel_4.5.3     splines_4.5.3      scales_1.4.0
[13] yaml_2.3.12        fastmap_1.2.0      lattice_0.22-9     R6_2.6.1
[17] labeling_0.4.3     generics_0.1.4     rbibutils_2.4.1    pillar_1.11.1
[21] RColorBrewer_1.1-3 tzdb_0.5.0         xfun_0.54          S7_0.2.2
[25] bit64_4.6.0-1      cli_3.6.6          mgcv_1.9-4         withr_3.0.3
[29] magrittr_2.0.5     Rdpack_2.6.6       digest_0.6.39      grid_4.5.3
[33] vroom_1.6.7        hms_1.1.4          nlme_3.1-168       lifecycle_1.0.5
[37] aoristAAR_0.1.1    vctrs_0.7.3        evaluate_1.0.5     glue_1.8.1
[41] farver_2.1.2       rmarkdown_2.30     tools_4.5.3        pkgconfig_2.0.3
[45] htmltools_0.5.9
```

References

Crema, E.R., 2025. A Bayesian alternative for aoristic analyses in archaeology. Archaeometry 67, 7–30. https://doi.org/10.1111/arcm.12984

Müller-Scheeßel, N., 2013. Untersuchungen zum Wandel hallstattzeitlicher Bestattungssitten in Süd- und Südwestdeutschland, Universitätsforschungen zur Prähistorischen Archäologie. R. Habelt, Bonn.

Turnbull, B.W., 1976. The empirical distribution function with arbitrarily grouped, censored and truncated data. Journal of the Royal Statistical Society. Series B (Methodological) 38, 290–295. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.2517-6161.1976.tb01597.x